Participant Information Sheet for 'Two-Phase research survey aiming to codesign and test a mobile application for information delivery and mental health monitoring for informal carers.'

Name of department: Computer and Information Sciences

Title of the study: Two-Phase research survey aiming to codesign and test a mobile application for information delivery and mental health monitoring for informal carers.

Introduction

This study is conducted by Aidan Gowdy, a fourth year Computer Science undergraduate student.

For contact, his University of Strathclyde email is aidan.gowdy.2022@uni.strath.ac.uk.

What is the purpose of this research?

This study is split into two phases. The aim of the first phase is to co-design a mobile application for information delivery tailored to informal carers by assessing the needs and opinions of current informal carers.

The aim of the second phase is to test an implementation of the system which was co-designed in phase one, and using short face-to-face interviews, gather feedback on what the system succeeds at and what

Do you have to take part?

Taking part in the survey is completely voluntary and the participant may choose to withdraw at any time in the survey without being treated any differently.

If a participant withdraws they may also request to have any data collected using their help expunged from the survey.

What will you do in the project?

In phase one of the survey, a short online questionnaire will be distributed to participants. Participants will be asked to answer questions on the desires for an application which will aim to support carers in their day-to-day caring experience. In total the questionnaire will not take longer than 15 minutes to complete.

In phase two of the survey, participants will be asked to test an implementation of the system in-person on the University of Strathclyde Campus and then provide their opinion of the software in a short face-to-face interview. The demo and interview should not take longer than an hour and a half and will take place in late February 2026.

Why have you been invited to take part?

Participants invited to take part all have some form of informal caring experience, this means caring for a person without being paid to do so.

What information is being collected in the project?

The only information being collected by the survey is the opinions of the participants, we will collect no identifying information.

These opinions will be personally assessed by Aidan and its feedback taken into account for the project.

In the second phase, we will collect signatures on consent forms, these will be stored securely for the duration of the project, and then shredded upon completion.

Who will have access to the information?
The only individuals with direct access to the information collected by the survey will be Aidan Gowdy and his project supervisor, Kieren Egan.

Where will the information be stored and how long will it be kept for?

In the first phase, the data will be collected using Qualtrics for the questionnaire then moved to the University of Strathclyde oneDrive, before being deleted from Qualtrics.

In the second phase, any information collected from the testing will be directly uploaded to the University of Strathclyde oneDrive. Consent forms will also be stored securely by Aidan.

All information will be deleted and consent forms shredded once Aidan's degree has been confirmed.

Thank you for reading this information – please ask any questions if you are unsure about what is written here.

What happens next?

If you would like to participate in the survey, please complete the questionnaire sent with this information sheet. Then, if you would like to participate in the in-person testing please email Aidan at his University email account.

Researcher contact details:

Aidan Gowdy – aidan.gowdy.2022@uni.strath.ac.uk

Chief Investigator details:

Kieren Egan – kieren.egan@strath.ac.uk

This research was granted ethical approval by the Department of Computer and Information Sciences Ethics Committee.

If you have any questions/concerns, during or after the research, or wish to contact an independent person to whom any questions may be directed or further information may be sought from, please contact: cis-ethics@strath.ac.uk